# Unit 3 — Media in Our Lives

Track E · Klasse 7 · Niveau E

**Niveau E**

## 1. Vocabulary

Match each item to its meaning or use it in a sentence.

| Term | Your note |
|---|---|
| screen time | |
| notification | |
| feed | |
| message | |
| stream | |
| story | |
| news | |

## 2. Reading

Read the text and use it for the activities below.

**Listening dialogue — *Three Screens***

The teacher reads aloud. Listen with closed books.

**Aisha.** I tried something this week. No phone after dinner. Just for one week.

**Ben.** Just for one week? That sounds impossible.

**Aisha.** It was hard for two days. After that, it was kind of nice.

**Ms. Reyes.** What did you do with the time you would have spent on the phone?

**Aisha.** I made dinner once. I drew badly. I went to bed earlier. The earlier bed was the biggest change.

**Vocabulary cluster — media**

| Noun | Verb |
|---|---|
| screen time | to scroll |
| notification | to swipe |
| feed | to post |
| message | to message |

| Noun | Verb |
|---|---|
| stream | to stream |
| story | to share |
| news | to follow / unfollow |

**Useful phrases.**

- *to be on your phone — I'm on my phone too much.*
- *to put your phone away — Put your phone away during dinner.*

- *to lose track of time — I lost track of time on TikTok.*

**Language focus — present perfect with *for* / *since***

Present perfect connects past to now. Use it for actions or states that started in the past and still continue, or for events without a clear past time marker.

- *I have not used my phone for three days.* (duration)
- *Aisha has read to her cat since Monday.* (start point)
- *We have known Ms. Reyes since September.* (start point)
- *Ben has played that game for two months.* (duration)

**For** + a length of time (*two days, three weeks, an hour*).

**Since** + a starting point (*Monday, my birthday, 2024*).

**L1 trap.** German *Perfekt* covers many cases where English uses simple past. *"Ich habe gestern viel ferngesehen"* in English is *"I watched a lot of TV yesterday"* — simple past, because of *yesterday*. Reserve present perfect for "still relevant now" contexts.

**Language focus — *asked* + *to* / *not to* (reported request)**

When you tell someone what another person asked, use:

- *Ms. Reyes asked us **to put** our phones in the box.*
- *Aisha asked Ben **not to post** that picture.*

The to-infinitive does not change with tense or person.

## 3. Practise

**Niveau G — controlled**

**A. for or since?**

1. I have known my best friend _____ five years.
2. I have not seen that film _____ 2024.
3. We have lived in this town _____ a long time.
4. Ben has been on his phone _____ this morning.

**B. Match the verb to the noun.**

| Verb | Noun |
|---|---|
| 1. to scroll | a. a story |
| 2. to swipe | b. a feed |
| 3. to post | c. a message |
| 4. to send | d. a screen |

**Niveau M — productive**

**C. Build a present perfect sentence with *for* / *since*.**

5. Aisha / not use / her phone / two evenings → ___
6. We / know / Ms. Reyes / September → ___
7. I / play / this game / a long time → ___

**D. Reported requests.**

8. ”Please charge my phone,” said Ben. → Ben asked his sister ___ .
9. ”Don’t read my messages,” said Aisha. → Aisha asked her brother ___ .

## 4. Your turn

**Writing task — *One Week, One Change*.** Write a short text proposing one change to your media habits for **one week only**. Cover three points:

1. *What I would stop or limit.*
2. *What I would do instead.*
3. *What I think will happen by the end of the week.*

Use *would* and *will* at least once each, and the present perfect at least once.

**Niveau G** — 60–80 words.
**Niveau M** — 100–120 words.

**Sample student response (Niveau M, 114 words)**

For one week I would stop using social media after dinner. I have noticed that I keep scrolling for almost an hour without remembering what I saw, and I always go to bed too late. Instead, I would read at least ten pages of a book, even if the book is boring at first. I would also walk the dog, who has waited for his evening walk for days now. By the end of the week, I think I will sleep better and remember more from school. I will probably miss some group chats, but my friends know where I live.

Strong moves: a small concrete subject (*after dinner*), a clear substitute (*read ten pages, walk the dog*), a self-aware closer (*my friends know where I live*). Improve by replacing *and* with *so* or *because* once.

## 5. Further reading / listening

- BBC Learning English — *6 Minute English: Phone-free schools.* https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english
- The Guardian — short opinion pieces on screen time and young people. https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/screen-time

- Cal Newport, *Digital Minimalism* — accessible chapter samples on the author's site at https://calnewport.com.